

Chacha Food Co. (002557.SZ): Profit alert: 2Q26 NI better than expected; Eyes on improving competition & cost outlook; Reiterate Buy

Chacha reported 1H26 preliminary results after market close on July 13, with implied 2Q26 NP mid-point at Rmb84mn, 12% beat vs GSe of Rmb76mn. 2Q26 NPM (mid-point) at 6.4% if using GSe sales. For 1H26, NP mid-point was at Rmb253mn, 4% beat vs GSe of Rmb244mn. Implied NPM at mid-point was 7.1% if assuming sales to recover 29% YoY to Rmb3.5bn, a beat vs GSe at 6.9%.

Echoing our view in the upgrade note & snack preview, we attribute the better-than-expected bottom line vs GSe to be driven by: 1) easier competition along with realignment in channel strategy; 2) sound margins on favourable sunflower seed cost outlook with improving supply demand dynamics.

In the upcoming results announcement, we think the focus will be on: 1) Initiatives for core categories and new products, and update on market competition dynamics; 2) Margin trajectory and procurement cost trends for nuts and sunflower seeds; Pricing strategies ahead; 3) Channel development updates, including online, value retailers, membership KAs and traditional channels; 4) More colour on shareholder returns.

We are Buy rated on Chacha with a 12m TP of Rmb22.5.

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Exhibit 1: Implied 2Q26 NP better than GSe

Chacha Food	1H26				
Unit: Rmb mn	Actual			GSe	Var (mid-point) vs Gse
	Lower end	Higher end	Mid-point		
Revenue				3,537	
NP	240	265	253	244	3.6%
Recurring NP	200	225	213	n.a.	n.a.
<i>Implying metrics</i>					
NP					
Implied NPM	6.8%	7.5%	7.1%	6.9%	0.2ppt
NP YoY	170.8%	199.0%	184.9%	175.1%	
Recurring NP					
Implied Recurring NPM	5.7%	6.4%	6.0%		
Chacha Food	Implied 2Q26				
Unit: Rmb mn	Actual			GSe	Var (mid-point) vs Gse
	Lower end	Higher end	Mid-point		
Revenue				1,315	
NP	72	97	84	76	11.5%
Recurring NP	51	76	64	n.a.	n.a.
<i>Implying metrics</i>					
NP					
Implied NPM	5.5%	7.4%	6.4%	5.7%	0.7ppt
NP YoY	529.6%	749.0%	639.3%	563.1%	
Recurring NP					
Implied Recurring NPM	3.9%	5.8%	4.8%		

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Bloomberg

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Chacha Food

We are Buy rated. Our 12-m TP of Rmb22.5 is based on a 16x 2026E P/E.

Key downside risks: 1) Higher-than-expected industry competition; 2) Higher-than-expected raw material costs; 3) Weaker-than-expected growth in emerging channels.

002557.SZ	12m Price Target: Rmb22.50	Price: Rmb19.80	Upside: 13.6%
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Buy	GS Forecast				
Market cap: Rmb10.0bn / \$1.5bn Enterprise value: Rmb7.0bn / \$1.0bn 3m ADTV: Rmb191.4mn / \$28.2mn China China Cosmetics, Pet & Food M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	Revenue (Rmb mn)	6,573.7	7,655.2	8,152.5	8,629.5
	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	541.1	890.7	916.4	961.3
	EPS (Rmb)	0.64	1.41	1.52	1.59
	P/E (X)	37.1	14.1	13.0	12.4
	P/B (X)	2.2	1.6	1.6	1.5
	Dividend yield (%)	4.2	4.3	4.6	4.8
	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	(4.6)	(3.4)	(3.4)	(3.3)
	CROCI (%)	9.9	13.0	12.3	12.1
	FCF yield (%)	(0.2)	8.7	6.9	7.3
		3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
	EPS (Rmb)	0.33	0.19	0.42	0.41

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 10 Jul 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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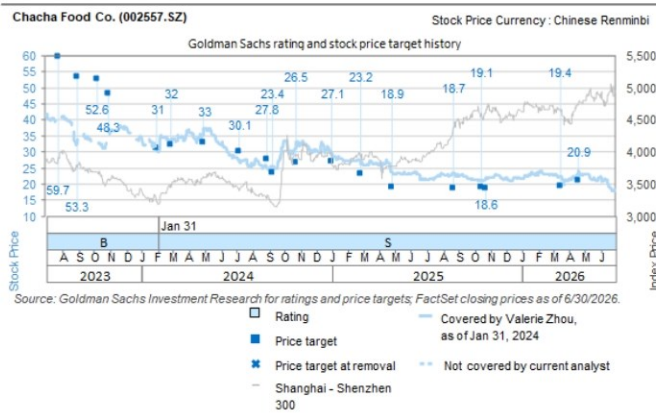
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Target price history table(s)

Chacha Food Co. (002557.SZ)

Date of report Target price (Rmb) Closing price (Rmb)

07-Jul-26	22.50	19.89
21-Apr-26	20.90	24.26
16-Mar-26	19.40	22.56
24-Oct-25	18.60	21.98
15-Oct-25	19.10	21.34
22-Aug-25	18.70	23.37
28-Apr-25	18.90	23.27
25-Feb-25	23.20	27.19
02-Jan-25	27.10	29.60
25-Oct-24	26.50	33.18
10-Sep-24	23.40	25.15
29-Aug-24	27.80	25.06
08-Jul-24	30.10	27.12
30-Apr-24	33.00	37.50
27-Feb-24	32.00	33.86
31-Jan-24	31.00	30.48
29-Oct-23	48.30	36.26
08-Oct-23	52.60	-
31-Aug-23	53.30	33.05
25-Jul-23	59.70	40.20

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